

October

QUEST Newsletter

Important Dates

10/1: Scholastic Art & Writing Award submissions open!

10/1: Math Madness during QRT

10/2 No School – Fall Break

10/5: CMU's WiDS NextGen Data Science Workshop application deadline

10/5: CMU's Women in Math registration deadline

10/7: Math Madness during QRT

10/8: PSAT given to all 9th, 10th & 11th grade students – half day schedule

10/15: Blood drive in the LGI

10/15: Math Madness during QRT

10/16: UPMC Medical Career Day

10/16: QRT career speaker, Dr. David Hall, Perfusionist

10/20: No school – fall break

10/21: Math Madness during QRT

10/23: KD Quiz team qualifying test - QRT

10/24: Early dismissal – end of grading period

10/28: Aspirations in Computing application deadline

10/29: Math Madness during QRT

10/30: Congressional App Challenge submission deadline

10/31: Lens On Litter Photo Contest Submission Deadline

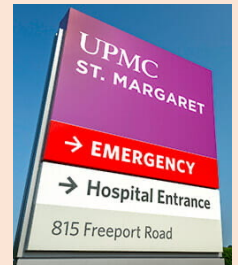


Are You Interested in a Medical Career Pathway?

Join us for a visit to UPMC St. Margaret on October 16th from 10am – 1pm (lunch will be provided). Participants will engage in a presentation and Q&A session with hospital leaders and tour the following departments to learn more about careers in these fields:

RADIOLOGY, PHARMACY, CARDIOLOGY, EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT and OPERATING ROOM.

Lunch and transportation will be provided. Participants Will also learn more about opportunities for volunteerism, Job shadowing, and paid positions at UPMC St. Margaret. Email Lisa_Gibson@fcsd.edu for a permission slip!



CARNEGIE MELLON
WOMEN'S MATH COMPETITION
SAVE THE DATE: OCTOBER 25, 2025

Contact Dr. Cowles to register your team: Lesley_Cowles@fcsd.edu
Register by October 5, 2025
Teams of three. One coach (contact) for each team.

What is CMWMC?
An in-person math contest for high school students, supporting our female and non-binary communities!

Students compete in teams of 3 on individual, guts, and relay round.

Topics include **Algebra/Number Theory, Combinatorics, and Geometry.**



Submit your art and/or writing now!



Scholastic Art & Writing Awards
<https://www.artandwriting.org/regions/PA002A>



AMC ENROLLMENT NOW OPEN!

The American Mathematics Competition is sponsored by the Mathematical Association of America, whose goal is to identify talent and foster a love for mathematics. Students are given 75 minutes to solve 25 multiple choice questions.

The competition will take place on November 5th during 3rd period in the MPR. FCASD covers the fee for participants. If you would like to participate, all you have to do is email

Lesley_Cowles@fcsd.edu or Lisa_Gibson@fcsd.edu. Learn more about the AMC by visiting <https://maa.org/student-programs/amc/>

The AMC helps students develop their problem-solving abilities and serves as the first step in qualifying for the USA team in prestigious international mathematics competitions, including the International Mathematical Olympiad.

INTRODUCE A GIRL TO ENGINEERING

JOIN WESTINGHOUSE WOMEN IN NUCLEAR TO:

ASK ME
ANYTHING

DISCOVER ENGINEERING
DISCIPLINES

CHALLENGE YOURSELF WITH
HANDS-ON ACTIVITIES

ASK YOUR
TEACHER
FOR
DETAILS!

WED. & THURS. NOVEMBER 12TH & 13TH, 8:45 AM* – 1:00 PM

WESTINGHOUSE WALTZ MILL

680 WALTZ MILL RD, RUFFS DALE, PA

*NETWORKING
BREAKFAST @ 8 AM

Westinghouse Women in Nuclear (WIN) and Westinghouse North American Young Generation in Nuclear (NAYGN) would like to invite interested **sophomores and juniors** to visit Westinghouse Waltz Mill for their Engineering Workshops! The engineering workshops provide a 1-day experience for students to discover engineering and challenge themselves with hands-on group projects. The goal of these workshops is to encourage students to consider a career in a STEM field. Each provides an overview of the potential for careers in engineering and other technical fields; and includes an overview of nuclear power, engineering disciplines, a career panel Q&A with Westinghouse engineers, and hands-on activities. Email Lisa_Gibson@fcasd.edu if you would like to attend.



USA Mathematical Talent Search

This **free** mathematics competition open to all middle and high school students. ROUND 1 PROBLEMS ARE NOW AVAILABLE AND DUE OCTOBER 7th!

USAMTS allows students a full month, or more, to work out their solutions. **Carefully written justifications** are required for each problem. The problems range in difficulty from being within the reach of most high school students to challenging the best students in the nation. Students may use any materials - books, calculators, computers - but all the work must be their own. The USAMTS is run on the honor system - it is an individual competition, whose competitive role is very secondary. (Although they do give prizes.) Student solutions to the USAMTS problems are graded by mathematicians and comments are returned to the students. *Their goal is to help all students develop their problem-solving skills, improve their technical writing abilities, and mature mathematically while having fun.* They wish to foster not only insight, ingenuity and creativity, but also the virtue of perseverance, which is equally essential in scientific endeavors. More details and registration link are available at <https://usamts.org/>



Tryout for the KD Quiz Team October 23rd - QRT

"KD Quiz" is a Saturday-morning high school academic quiz show presented by KDKA-TV in partnership with GBU Life. It is open to students from the KDKA-TV viewing area from 81 high schools who compete in teams of three and answer questions from a variety of curricular areas. The program host is KDKA meteorologist Ray Petelin. Email Lisa_Gibson@fcasd.edu for a pass.

Lens on Litter Photo Contest

October 31st submission deadline!

The PA Resources Council is now accepting entries to the annual Gene Capaldi 'Lens on Litter' Photo Contest. There are two categories for entry, adult and students through grade 12. Entries are judged on six criteria and there are cash prizes. Photos should demonstrate how litter threatens public health and safety, scenic beauty, property values, the environment, pets or wildlife. Entries will be judged on six criteria: anti-litter message, originality, photographic technique, quality of photo, originality of title and severity of the litter. Contestants are also encouraged to safely initiate a clean-up of the subject area and provide a photo of the results of your efforts for additional judging points. First, second and third place prizes will be awarded in each category with the first-place winner receiving \$500, second-place \$250 and third-place \$100. **NEW IN 2025!** This year a new BEFORE & AFTER category — sponsored by Keep America Beautiful — has been added to the contest. To qualify for this category, clean up efforts must be registered with Keep Pennsylvania Beautiful's Pick up PA program. Enter at <https://prc.org/what-we-do/lens-on-litter-contest/>



Pictured above is a 2021 first-place winning entry in Pennsylvania Resources Council's Lens on Litter contest. The photo by Fox Chapel Area High School graduate Zoe Broyles is entitled "Rachel Carson's Dream."

THE COOLIDGE

A SCHOLARSHIP FOR AMERICA

The Coolidge Scholarship is a full-ride, four-year, merit scholarship that recipients may use for undergraduate study at any accredited college or university in the United States. Any high school junior who plans to enroll in college in the fall of 2026 is eligible to apply. Winners may use the scholarship to pursue any academic major.

Academic excellence is the primary criterion considered by the Coolidge Scholarship. Secondary criteria include an interest in public policy and an appreciation of the values President Coolidge championed. Successful candidates will also demonstrate humility and have a record of genuine service to their communities. A complete description of the scholarship's criteria is available at <https://coolidgescholars.org/selection-criteria/>

The competition for the Coolidge Scholarship is significant -- only a few new Coolidge Scholarships are awarded each year from a pool of candidates that spans the entire country. Even so, students have reported to us in past years they were glad to have applied even if they didn't win, because the experience helped prepare them for college applications later on. The winner of the 2025 Coolidge Scholarship was Fox Chapel Area High School Student Uyana Kubini! Furthermore, the Coolidge Foundation invites one hundred of the top Coolidge Scholarship applicants to participate in the Coolidge Senators Program, which includes an all-expenses-paid summit gathering and a \$1,000 scholarship. Scholarship applicants are automatically considered for the Senators Program. The scholarship application, along with additional information, can be accessed on their scholarship site:

coolidgescholars.org.

Questions can be answered by email at coolidgescholars@coolidgefund.org or by phone at (202) 827-4291.



North American Computational Linguistics Open Competition

Registration for this competition is set to open in the upcoming weeks. The competition will be held on Thursday, January 29th and the invitation round on March 19th. Email Lesley_Cowles@fcsd.edu if you want to receive registration information once it is open.

Free Data Science Workshop at CMU



Women in
Data Science
Worldwide

Carnegie Mellon University
Statistics & Data Science



Saturday
Oct. 18,
2025

WiDS NextGen

You're about to engage with real-world data science challenges using sophisticated reasoning frameworks that professional data scientists rely on. This isn't just about learning tools - it's about developing the kind of thinking that will serve you in any career path, from business and healthcare to education and social justice work.

This is a one-day workshop from 9:00 AM to 3:00 PM for Pittsburgh area high school students. Scan the QR Code to apply!



LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Master systematic approaches to complex stakeholder analysis
- Apply creative reasoning frameworks to generate breakthrough insights
- Design ethical data visualizations that serve understanding without manipulation
- Predict and mitigate unintended consequences of data-driven decisions
- Develop responsible influence strategies for diverse audiences
- Reflect metacognitively on your own reasoning and learning processes



Carnegie Mellon University, 5000 Forbes Ave, Pittsburgh, PA 15213

The [Department of Statistics & Data Science](#) at Carnegie Mellon University and [WiDS Worldwide](#) proudly invites Pittsburgh area high school students of all backgrounds to apply to the WiDS NextGen workshop. The one day workshop will be held on Carnegie Mellon's campus on October 18, 2025 from 9:00 AM to 3:00 PM.

You're about to engage with real-world data science challenges using sophisticated reasoning frameworks that professional data scientists rely on. This isn't just about learning tools - it's about developing the kind of thinking that will serve you in any career path, from business and healthcare to education and social justice work.

*There is NO COST to attend!

*Breakfast and lunch will be provided.

Key Details:

Date: Saturday, October 18, 2025 | 9:00 AM to 3:00 PM

Location: Carnegie Mellon University, 5000 Forbes Ave, Pittsburgh, PA 15213

Who: Pittsburgh-area high school students of all backgrounds

For additional information, please visit:

<https://www.widsworldwide.org/learn/next-gen/>
or feel free to contact wids@andrew.cmu.edu.

Upon acceptance to the workshop, more information will be provided.

The application deadline is Sunday, October 5, 2025 at 11:59 pm ET. Decisions will be announced by October 10, 2025.



**AWARD FOR
ASPIRATIONS
IN COMPUTING**
an NCWIT Award

THE WORLD NEEDS YOUR VOICE

TO INSPIRE STUDENTS
TO CHAMPION DIVERSITY
TO ENCOURAGE EXPLORATION
TO IGNITE POSITIVE CHANGE



Winning an AiC High School Award not only looks great on college applications but also connects awardees to the Aspirations in Computing Community of 30,000+ technologists who share their passion, providing a supportive network and valuable connections in the tech industry.

The AiC High School Award honors 9th-12th grade women, genderqueer, and non-binary students for their computing-related achievements and interests, encourages them to pursue their passions in computing and tech, and connects them to a community of 30,000 technologists.

This award is different because it uplifts and encourages technologists at ALL stages of their journeys! Please encourage all of your eligible students to apply. **There are award designations for ALL levels of technical ability, including students with little to no experience.**

The Aspirations in Computing (AiC) High School Award is now accepting high school students' applications! **Student applications are due October 28, 2025.**

Apply today at

<https://www.aspirations.org/award-programs/aic-high-school-award>



Health Career Scholars Academy

SAD NEWS...the University of Pittsburgh Health Career Scholars Academy has been discontinued.

Normally, we would be announcing that this is the month to apply to the Health Career Scholars Academy, but with the retirement of the Program Director, the UPHCSA program has been discontinued and will not be held in 2026. Current high school freshman and sophomores are being encouraged to visit the Southwest AHEC website (www.southwestahec.org) for information about a one-week summer program (non-residential). Other Pennsylvania AHECs may also offer summer programming. In addition, you may visit the website for the National Conference of Governors' Schools (www.ncogs.us) for programs in other states.

BILL of RIGHTS INSTITUTE



The 2025-2026 MyImpact Challenge is Now Open!

In July 2026, America celebrates 250 years as a nation. The Bill of Rights Institute is spotlighting young people who are living the ideals of 1776 and demonstrating the Founding principles and civic virtues through [MyImpact Challenge](#).

MyImpact Challenge is our national civic engagement contest that highlights students actively engaged in service, volunteerism, or entrepreneurship in their communities. The contest is open to U.S. citizens and U.S.-based young people between the ages of 13 and 19. Students with an active project that demonstrates their impact can enter and:

- Win up to \$10,000,
- Boost college applications and resumes,
- Secure funding to further innovative projects,
- Be recognized in the community,
- and connect with other young changemakers.

What are the Contest Requirements?

To submit a project, students must describe an idea they have envisioned and brought to life. Each project must have three components:

- A written essay to connect their project to our [founding principles](#) and [virtues](#),
- A project report that highlights their inspiration, their project execution, and their impact,
- and visual documentation illustrating impact.

The deadline to enter MyImpact Challenge is Sunday, May 3, 2026, 11:59 PM.

https://billofrightsinstitute.org/my-impact-challenge?utm_source=Salesforce%20Marketing%20Cloud&utm_medium=eMail&utm_campaign=MIC+National+Fair+-+Teacher+-+Open+Announcement+-+9.05.2025&utm_id=1713969&sfmc_id=374838589



Preliminary SAT®/National Merit Scholarship Qualifying Test

All 9th, 10th and 11th grade students will take the PSAT on Wednesday, October 8. You will need to use school issued devices to take the exam. If you

do not have a device, one will be provided in your QRT for you to use. Digital practice PSAT exams can be found [HERE](#). For more information regarding the PSAT, contact your school counselor.

Lumiere Scholars Essay Award 2025

A world-class essay competition for ambitious high school students.

Submission Deadline:
November 2nd, 2025

Shortlist

Announcement:
December 1st, 2025

Result Announcement
December 16th, 2025

The Lumiere Scholars Essay Award invites high school students to examine issues that matter to them, cross disciplinary lines, test assumptions, and defend their arguments with rigorous evidence. Essay entries are reviewed by our Academic Advisory Committee, an international panel of distinguished professors and researchers.

6 winners from 3 categories (Humanities, STEM, and Social Sciences) will receive a total of \$20,000 in cash prizes and scholarships.

Free to enter and open worldwide, the award celebrates rising thinkers, sparks dialogue about the ideas shaping our future and continues Lumiere's mission of empowering the next generation of researchers.

<https://www.lumiere-education.com/lumiere-scholars-essay-award>

You can still join
FC Hacks!



CONGRESSIONAL APP CHALLENGE

The most prestigious prize in student computer science.

Transforming how Congress views computer science and STEM.

ELIGIBILITY AND AGE DIVISION

- High school student at the time of app submission.
- Register as individuals or as teams of up to four.
 - No more than four students are allowed to form a team.
 - At least half of the teammates must be eligible to compete in the district in which they are participating in.
- Compete in the district they reside in or the district they attend school in.
- Competing students must be U.S. residents at the time of submission. There is no citizen requirement for students.
- More information / registration: <https://www.congressionalappchallenge.us/>

Contact: Dr. Cowles for more information - Lesley_Cowles@fcasd.edu



Connecting today's
Congress with
tomorrow's innovators.



US Court
of Appeals

Video Contest – Importance of American Democracy

Entries must be submitted by November 3, 2025. The winner will be selected in early to mid-November 2025. PRIZE: An award will be presented to the winner in the winner's home district (or division) during a naturalization ceremony. The winning video will be played during all districts' naturalization ceremonies until the next winner is selected. The winning video also will appear on the Third Circuit's website, district websites, and other related social media platforms. The award will be presented in early to mid-December, in celebration of Bill of Rights Day.

FOR QUESTIONS ABOUT THE CONTEST PLEASE CONTACT: Courts_Community_Rule_of_Law @ca3.uscourts.gov or 267-299-4306

For more information and to enter, visit:

<https://www.ca3.uscourts.gov/news/video-contest-importance-american-democracy>



American Scholastic Mathematics Association

Annual Mathematics Contest

for

Junior, Intermediate and Senior High Schools
Serving Schools Internationally since 1982

6 Contests

November - April

Usually second week of each month.

Competitions held in the Library Classroom

Join The Competition



2025-26 MAA AMC

Email Lesley_Cowles@fcasd.edu for more information!

Carnegie Mellon University

Upcoming Student Events

CMU will be hosting two Fall 2025 High School Outreach Events:

High School Day (Saturday, November 15th, 2025) and **High School Mentoring Day** (Saturday, November 1st, 2025), both taking place in-person at Carnegie Mellon University.

These events are available to all current high school students.

High School Mentoring Day 2025 (November 1st, 2025):

The mentorship program aims to connect high school girls in the local Pittsburgh community to current student mentors at CMU. Through small group and one-on-one conversations, high school students will learn about the different engineering disciplines they can pursue as well as how those disciplines are taught at CMU!

Get a chance to reconnect with your mentor, meet a new mentor, do some bonding activities, and enjoy some lunch together! Students can fill out [this form](#) to register for High School Mentoring Day.

High School Day 2025 (November 15th, 2025):

High School Day is a great opportunity for high school students to explore various fields in STEM. Students will participate in three workshops of their choice, two core engineering workshops and one special topic workshop. These workshops begin with an overview of the discipline and followed by a hands-on activity. The workshops will be delivered by renowned CMU faculty and some amazing PhD candidates!

Every year, students have been invited to participate in core engineering workshops including:

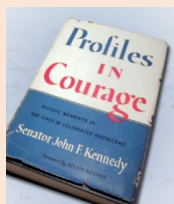
Chemical Engineering, Electrical and Computer Engineering, Mechanical Engineering, Materials Science and Engineering, Biomedical Engineering, Civil and Environmental Engineering, and Engineering and Public Policy.

Students are also able to participate in one special topic workshop. Although this year's list of special topic workshops has not yet been finalized, likely special topic workshops include:

Computer Science, Game Design, Sustainable Earth, Music Technology, Rocket Command, Robotics, Solar-Power Boat Racing, Theme Park, and Engineering.

Breakfast and lunch will be provided as well as raffle prizes for attendees!!

To register for **High School Mentoring Day**, fill out [this form](#).



The John F. Kennedy Profiles in Courage Essay Contest is officially open! You can win up to \$10,000 for participating!

The contest deadline is January 12, 2026. Visit

<https://www.jfklibrary.org/essaycontest> for more information and to enter!



Patriots of the American Revolution Essay Contest

The NSDAR sponsors a high school-level essay contest focused on figures of the American Revolution, in preparation for the 250th anniversary of the nation's founding. The contest is open to students in grades 9 through 12. All grades will be judged together, with one winner chosen at the chapter level. The deadline for student essay submissions is **Wednesday, November 25, 2025**.

Our chapter will award each essay writer a Patriots of the American Revolution Essay Participation Certificate. We will select one essay as the chapter winner (which will be awarded a bronze medal, DAR certificate and monetary award), which will then enter the state competition. States will then select one essay winner to represent the state for judging at the Division level, and a state level winner certificate, silver medal and monetary gift will be presented to the state winners. Each Division level will also have one winner, who will receive a certificate and a book. The national winner will receive a National Winner Certificate, pin and monetary award, presented at Continental Congress. The winning essay may appear in official DAR communications. National second and third place winners will also receive a certificate and monetary award.

The topic for this year is: Select a figure from the era of the American Revolution (1773-1783). Discuss how he or she influenced the course of the American Revolution, who he or she was and his/her contribution to the founding of a new nation. Figures may be any person, whether a well-known figure or an everyday man, woman, or child who supported the American Revolution in ways large or small. **If you are interested in entering this contest, email Lisa_Gibson@fcasd.edu for entry requirements.**



Blood Drive!

**Wednesday, October 15, 2025
7:30 a.m. to 1:15 p.m.**

Students (age 16+) AND community members are invited to donate!

Get 2 community service hours and save 3 lives!

PLEASE DONATE TO HELP OUR LOCAL PATIENTS AND TO SUPPORT THE FCAHS SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM!

Sign up Here →

...or visit the sign-up table in the commons area!



Questions? See Mrs. Gibson in room 168.